

Dominic Zappia

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EDUCATION

University of Wisconsin-Madison

Bachelor of Arts: Economics, Political Science & Philosophy
Data Science, Digital Media Analytics & PEPP Minors
Comprehensive Honors in the Liberal Arts & Political Science
2025 Letters & Science Dean's Prize Winner

Graduated: May 2025

GPA: 3.8/4.0

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE & SKILLS

Stanford University – McCoy Family Center for Ethics in Society

Tech Ethics & Policy Rising Scholar Pre-Doctoral Research Assistant for Professor Rob Reich

September 2025-Present

- Served as Head Course Coordinator for new large lecture course on AI Governance (100+ Students)
- Completed research memos on AI Governance, philosophical implications of AI use, and history of technology

Associated Students of Madison

Student Body President & Chair

April 2024-April 2025

- Directed and connected student-led campaigns to create meaningful change through advocacy work
- Organized 150+ students between 50+ committees, providing direct support and clear communication
- Designed and implemented a \$1,500,000 budget for FY26
- Represented 50,000+ undergraduate and graduate students during large-scale campus conflicts

Student Body Vice-President & Vice-Chair

April 2023-April 2024

- Chaired Student Council Executive Committee through crisis situations
- Organized 30+ student development and programming activities

UW-Madison University Housing

House Fellow – International Learning Community

January 2022-August 2024

- Built an impassioned and supportive community of 45+ students through community-building programs
- Resolved crisis situations and conflict between students through mediation and dialogue

Madison West High School Mock Trial

Volunteer Coach

September 2021-May 2025

- Organized and educated high school students on principles of the trial system
- Led a passionate group of 50+ students and compete in regional, state, and national competitions

Professional Skills: Leadership, Policy Analysis, Team Coordination, Event Planning, Public Speaking, Teaching & Mentoring

SELECTED ACADEMIC PROJECTS & SKILLS

Senior Honors Thesis – Political Science

Changing Hearts & Minds: Analyzing r/ChangeMyView in Theory and Practice

- Synthesized literature in epistemology, democratic theory, and political philosophy to research online communities
- Utilized web scraping and data analysis to empirically test hypotheses

Economics Research Project

Exploring Selective Colleges: Does College Selectivity Increase Future Earnings?

- Performed statistical analysis to evaluate the relationship between college selectivity and future income
- Presented conclusions in an accessible and intuitive online dashboard for further research

University of Arizona Philosophy, Politics, Economics and Law Summer School Presentation

Ordinal Reduced Form Employee/Firm Trust Game

- Applied a game theoretic model to a contemporary issue to gain new insight on gamification and labor
- Awarded second place by a panel of academic economists, legal scholars, and political theorists

Selected Graduate Level Coursework

Democratic Theory (UW-Madison, Political Science 601)

Contemporary Political Theory (Stanford, Political Science 437C)

Concepts and Tools for Data Analysis and Visualization (UW-Madison, Journalism 677)

Academic Skills: Academic Writing, R, Stata, Python, Tableau, Data Visualization & Analysis, Literature Reviews